Internal AI Helpdesk Assistant – Deployment Requirements

1 Overview

The organization is evaluating AI-powered helpdesk assistants to support internal IT and HR workflows across approximately 120 employees. The goal of this initiative is to reduce manual workload, improve response consistency, and ensure traceability of all system-generated outputs for audit and compliance purposes.

The selected system will be deployed across multiple departments and is expected to integrate seamlessly with existing enterprise tools. The system must be scalable, secure, and capable of handling structured and unstructured data inputs.

2 Mandatory Requirements

- Single Sign-On (SSO) must integrate with Okta-based identity systems.
- Audit logging must be available for all system interactions and administrative actions.
- Customer data must be deletable within 30 days of contract termination.
- The system must support ingestion of PDF and Markdown documentation.
- The total Year 1 cost must not exceed $18,000.

Secondary Objectives include: -

- Improving employee satisfaction
- Reducing operational overhead
- Enabling analytics-driven decision-making

3 Functional Requirements

3.1 Authentication and Access Control

The system must support Single Sign-On (SSO) using enterprise identity providers, specifically Okta. Role-based access control (RBAC) must be implemented to restrict access based on user roles such as employee, admin, and auditor.

3.2 Knowledge Ingestion

The system must support ingestion of documentation in PDF and Markdown formats. It should be capable of processing multi-page documents, extracting structured information, and updating its knowledge base dynamically.

3.3 Query Handling

The system must handle natural language queries and provide context-aware responses. It should support multi-turn conversations and maintain context across sessions where applicable.

3.4 Integration Capabilities

The system should integrate with Slack for internal communication workflows. Additionally, it should expose APIs for integration with other enterprise systems.

4 Compliance and Security Requirements

4.1 Audit Logging

All user interactions and administrative actions must be logged. Logs must be accessible for auditing purposes and should include timestamps, user identifiers, and action details.

4.2 Data Retention and Deletion

Customer and employee data must be deletable within 30 days of contract termination. The system should provide mechanisms for data export and deletion requests.

4.3 Security Standards

The system must adhere to industry-standard security practices including encryption at rest and in transit, access controls, and regular security audits.

5 Performance Requirements

The system should be capable of handling concurrent queries from multiple users without degradation in performance. Response times should ideally be under 2 seconds for standard queries.

6 Cost Constraints

The total cost of ownership for the first year must not exceed $18,000. This includes licensing, integration, and maintenance costs. Solutions requiring enterprise-only upgrades for core functionality are not preferred.

7 Deployment and Timeline

The target deployment timeline is 6–8 weeks. The vendor must provide support during onboarding and initial setup phases.

8 Evaluation Criteria

Systems will be evaluated based on:

- Compliance with mandatory requirements

- Ease of integration

- Scalability and performance

- Cost-effectiveness

- Quality of documentation and support

Systems failing mandatory requirements may be rejected unless clear mitigation strategies are provided.

9 Conclusion

The selected system should align closely with organizational goals, provide measurable efficiency improvements, and meet all compliance and security requirements.